



# Daniel Sánchez-García

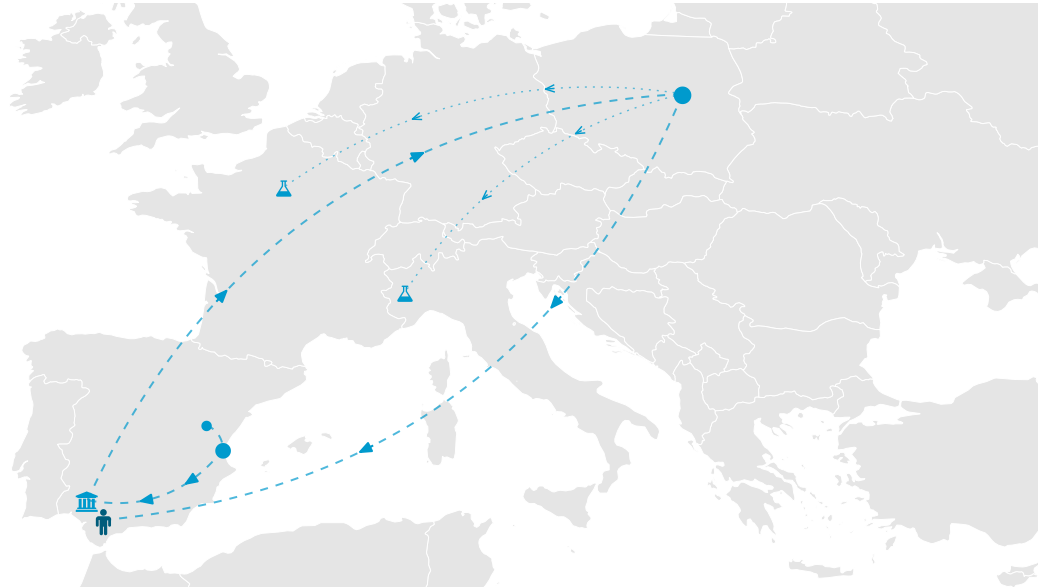
PHD IN BIOLOGY

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## ✈ My journey



## 🏢 Professional experience

### Postdoc Researcher

DOÑANA BIOLOGICAL STATION (EBD-CSIC), DEPARTMENT OF CONSERVATION BIOLOGY AND GLOBAL CHANGE, SEVILLE (SPAIN)

January 2025 - present

### Specialist in ant species identification

DOÑANA BIOLOGICAL STATION (EBD-CSIC), DEPARTMENT OF CONSERVATION BIOLOGY AND GLOBAL CHANGE, SEVILLE (SPAIN)

May 2024 - Jun 2024

- Identification of ant species from pitfall trap samples from Spain, France, Belgium and the Netherlands, contributing to ecological research and biodiversity assessments through taxonomic expertise.

## 🎓 Education

### PhD in Biology

MUSEUM AND INSTITUTE OF ZOOLOGY, WARSAW (POLAND)

Oct 2019 - Sep 2024

- PhD Thesis: The project aimed to get a better understanding of how reintroductions of parasites work, we performed a multi-level comparison of source and reintroduced populations of *Phengaris teleius* by studying 1) population genetics, 2) morphology of adult butterflies and 3) behavioural, chemical and acoustical adaptations of butterfly caterpillar to the *Myrmica* host ants.

### Master of Biodiversity and Conservation Biology

UNIVERSIDAD PABLO DE OLAVIDE, SEVILLA (SPAIN)

Oct 2017 - Jul 2018

- MSc Thesis (Thesis grade: 9.8 - Honors with Distinction; Overall degree grade: 9.11): The work aimed to study the effect of temperature over ant assemblages from different habitats, applying different ecological perspectives. Taxonomic and functional diversity were studied, and a new index was developed to study the direct effect of temperature over the interspecific competition.

### Degree of Biology

UNIVERSITAT DE VALÈNCIA, VALENCIA (SPAIN)

Sep 2012 - Sep 2016

- BSc thesis (Thesis grade: 9.5): The work aimed to provide new knowledge about the ant communities of Sierra de Javalambre. The main goals were: 1) study how ant species are distributed along the altitudinal gradient, studying variables like ground temperature, nest density and stone density; 2) study the patching effect of *Juniperus sabina* over ant activity and nesting areas.

### Prof. Luca Pietro Casacci

UNIVERSITY OF TURIN, DEPARTMENT OF LIFE SCIENCES AND SYSTEMS BIOLOGY, TURIN (ITALY)

Oct 2021

- I received training in recording insect vibroacoustic signals, sonogram analysis and performing behavioral assays, which enhanced my skills in experimental design and data interpretation.

### Prof. Patrizia d'Ettorre

SORBONNE PARIS NORTH UNIVERSITY, LABORATORY OF EXPERIMENTAL AND COMPARATIVE ETHOLOGY, PARIS (FRANCE)

Jan 2020 - Feb 2020

- I received training in CG-MS analysis of cuticular hydrocarbons and bioinformatics workflows, which deepened my understanding of chemical communication in social insects and enhanced my analytical skills.

## Internships

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### Scientific assistant

VALENCIAN INSTITUTE OF AGRICULTURAL RESEARCH (IVIA), DEPARTMENT OF ENTOMOLOGY, VALENCIA (SPAIN)

Feb 2016 - May 2016

- Internship with the researcher Alejandro Tena working on a biological control applied study about the effect of the presence of the ant *Lasius grandis* on the behaviour of the parasitoid wasp *Anagyrus pseudococci* on mealybug colonies of *Planococcus citri* (pest of citrus).

### Environmental manager

AGRICULTURAL, STOCKBREEDING AND ENVIRONMENTAL PUBLIC SERVICE (DIPUTACIÓN GENERAL DE ARAGÓN), TERUEL (SPAIN)

Jul 2015 - Sep 2015

- Internship with the environmental manager José Manuel González working on environmental impact reports; monitoring of fish river population dynamic for its management and conservation using electric fishing techniques; monitoring of deer population dynamic for its management and conservation in the Hunting National Reserve "Montes Universales"; management and translocation of native plant species.

## Publications

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Also in my *Google Scholar* profile and available to download from my Website.

Ambakina, H., Gómez, K., Monzenga, J. C., **Sánchez-García, D.**, & Dekoninck, W. (2026). Uncovering ant diversity across forest successional stages in the yangambi biosphere reserve (DRC): Insights from winkler and pitfall trap sampling. *African Invertebrates*, 67, 65–91. <https://doi.org/10.3897/AfrInvertebr.67.180461>

**Sánchez-García, D.**, Wynhoff, I., Kajzer-Bonk, J., Sztencel-Jablonka, A., Nowicki, P., Casacci, L. P., & Witek, M. (2024). Temporal and spatial variation of morphological traits and genetic structure in *Phengaris teleius* myrmecophilous butterflies following habitat and climate changes three decades after reintroduction. *Global Ecology and Conservation*, 54, e03104. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gecco.2024.e03104>

Trigos-Peral, G., Maák, I. E., Schmid, S., Chudzik, P., Czaczkes, T. J., Witek, M., Casacci, L. P., **Sánchez-García, D.**, Lorincz, Á., Kochanowski, M., & Heinze, J. (2024). Urban abiotic stressors drive changes in the foraging activity and colony growth of the black garden ant *Lasius niger*. *Science of the Total Environment*, 915, 170157. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2024.170157>

**Sánchez-García, D.**, Cerdá, X., & Angulo, E. (2022). Temperature or competition: Which has more influence on Mediterranean ant communities? *PLoS ONE*, 17(4 April), 1–16. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0267547>

Angulo Aguado, E., Castro Cobo, S., **Sánchez-García, D.**, Sergio, F., Reyes-López, J. L., Álvarez Blanco, P., & Cerdá Sureda, X. (2019). ¿Se podrá controlar la expansión de la invasora hormiga argentina en Doñana? In J. Junoy (Ed.), *Especies exóticas invasoras: Catedra de parques nacionales* (pp. 249–262). Editorial Universidad de Alcalá.

García, F., Cuesta-Segura, A. D., Espadaler, X., García, J. C., & **Sánchez-García, D.** (2019). *Lasius piliferus* Seifert, 1992: descripción de la reina y actualización de su distribución ibérica (Hymenoptera: Formicidae). *Boletín de La Sociedad Entomológica Aragonesa (S.E.A.)*, 65, 39–44.

García García, F., Espadaler Gelabert, X., Cuesta-Segura, A. D., & **Sánchez-García, D.** (2018). Primera cita ibérica para *Temnothorax conatensis* Galkowski & Lebas, 2016, y actualización de la distribución para *Temnothorax grouvellei* (bondroit, 1918) (Hymenoptera: Formicidae). *Iberomyrmex*, 10, 22–27.

Espadaler, X., **Sánchez-García, D.**, & García-García, F. (2017). *Temnothorax ibericus* Menozzi (1922), un endemismo ibérico orófilo (Hymenoptera, Formicidae). *Iberomyrmex*, 9, 5–9.

**Sánchez-García, D.,** & Espadaler, X. (2017). Una nueva especie parásita social para la península ibérica. *Bothriomyrmex comunista* Santschi, 1919 (Hymenoptera: Formicidae) en España. *Iberomyrmex*, 9, 11–13.

**Sánchez-García, D.,** & Espadaler, X. (2015). *Cardiocondyla obscurior* Wheeler, 1929 (Hymenoptera, Formicidae) en España. *Iberomyrmex*, 7, 7–9.

## Conference talks and posters

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**Sánchez-García, D.,** Taheri, A., Cerdá, X., & Angulo, E. (2025). ANT HUNTERS: A citizen science initiative for ant biodiversity research. *XIX National Congress y XVI Iberoamerican Congress of Ethology and Evolutionary Ecology*, Seville, Spain (Poster).

**Sánchez-García, D.,** Taheri, A., Cerdá, X., & Angulo, E. (2025). ANT HUNTERS: La ciudadanía a la caza de la biodiversidad de hormigas. *XIX International Congress of Myrmecology. Taxomara 2025, Girona*, Spain (Poster).

**Sánchez-García, D.,** Wynhoff, I., d'Etorre, P., Leroy, C., Joanna, K.-B., Maák, E., Barbero, F., Casacci, L. P., & Witek, M. (2025). Reintroduction provides insight into multimodal mimicry evolution in an ant social parasite. *XIX National Congress y XVI Iberoamerican Congress of Ethology and Evolutionary Ecology*, Seville, Spain (Talk).

**Sánchez-García, D.,** Wynhoff, I., d'Etorre, P., Leroy, C., Kajzer-Bonk, J., Maák, I. E., Barbero, F., Casacci, L. P., & Witek, M. (2025). Mariposas mirmecófilas reescriben su lenguaje para adaptarse a nuevas hormigas huésped. *XIX International Congress of Myrmecology. Taxomara 2025, Girona*, Spain (Talk).

**Sánchez-García, D.,** Cerdá, X., & Angulo, E. (2024). Modificación del hábitat como herramienta de control de la invasión de la hormiga argentina. *XVIII International Congress of Myrmecology. Taxomara 2024, Malaga*, Spain (Talk).

**Sánchez-García, D.,** Cerdá, X., & Angulo, E. (2024). Recovering native ant communities by removing suitable conditions for the invasive argentine ant. *IV International Young Researchers Conference on Invasive Species. IyrCIS*, Online (Talk).

**Sánchez-García, D.,** Casacci, L. P., Wynhoff, I., Kajzer-Bonk, J., Sztencel-Jablonka, A., Nowicki, P., & Witek, M. (2023). Changes in morphology and genetic structure in two populations of phengaris (=maculinea) teleius 30 years after separation. *Butterfly Conservation Symposium 2023, Wyboston*, England (Talk).

**Sánchez-García, D.,** Casacci, L. P., Wynhoff, I., Kajzer-Bonk, J., Nowicki, P., & Witek, M. (2022). Short-time evolution in the morphology of the myrmecophilous maculinea teleius butterfly. *8th Polish Evolutionary Conference 2022, Toruń*, Poland (Talk).

**Sánchez-García, D.** (2019). Fotografía de insectos: Material, técnicas y aplicaciones. *XIV International Congress of Myrmecology. Taxomara 2019, Chefchaoué*, Morocco (Talk).

**Sánchez-García, D.,** Cerdá, X., & Angulo, E. (2018). ¿Temperatura o competencia, qué afecta más a las hormigas de doñana? *XIII Iberian Congress of Myrmecology. Taxomara 2018, León*, Spain (Talk).

**Sánchez-García, D.,** Cuesta-Segura, A. D., Herraiz, J. A., Trigos-Peral, G., García, F. G., Catarineu, C., González, J. A., & Martínez, J. A. F. (2017). Listado actualizado de las hormigas de la península ibérica e islas baleares (hymenoptera: formicidae). *XII Iberian Congress of Myrmecology. Taxomara 2017, Madrid*, Spain (Poster).

**Sánchez-García, D.** (2016). Aspectos ecológicos sobre la mirmecocenosis de solana de la sierra de javalambre (teruel). *XI Iberian Congress of Myrmecology. Taxomara 2016, Murcia*, Spain (Talk).

## Funding

|             |                                                                                                                                                                               |                                |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 2022 - 2025 | PRELUDIUM grant 2021/41/N/NZ8/04360 (NCN, Poland). Bacteria – ant – plant interaction: the effect of ants as bacteria dispersal vectors and indirect drivers of plant health. | 202.001 pln; aprox. 46.000 eur |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|

## Awards

|      |                                                                                                                                                     |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 | Award for the best oral presentation at the XIX International Congress of the Spanish Society of Ethology and Evolutionary Ecology (Seville, Spain) |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Organization of Conferences and Scientific Events

|      |                                                            |                                               |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 2021 | XVI International Conference of Myrmecology, Taxomara 2021 | Organizing Committee and Scientific Committee |
| 2020 | XV International Conference of Myrmecology, Taxomara 2020  | Organizing Committee and Scientific Committee |

## Reviews

Manuscripts reviewed for: Applied and Environmental Microbiology (1), Insect Conservation and Diversity (2), Plant-Arthropod Interactions (1), Polish Journal of Ecology (1)

## Workshops

|      |                                                                                                    |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 | Invited to participate in InvaPact III: Analysis of the ecological effects of biological invasions |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Courses

|      |                                                           |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 | Systematic Reviews and Meta-analysis in R                 |
| 2025 | Optimizing the use of R for ecological analyses           |
| 2019 | Advanced University Course in Ecological Network Analysis |
| 2018 | Animal Tracking Course                                    |

## Memberships

|            |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| since 2025 | SORTEE - Society for Open, Reliable, and Transparent Ecology and Evolutionary Biology  |
| since 2012 | Iberian Asociation of Myrmecology (member of the Governing Board)                     |

## Skills

### TECHNICAL SKILLS

#### Coding Languages

R

#### general R packages

markdown – ggplot2 – geomorph –  
vegan

#### Other

GCMS – morphometrics – network  
analysis – genetics – ant taxonomy

| Skill     | Spanish | English |
|-----------|---------|---------|
| Reading   | Native  | B2      |
| Writing   | Native  | B2      |
| Listening | Native  | B2      |
| Speaking  | Native  | B2      |

Common European Framework of Reference for Languages: A1/A2: Basic User. B1/B2: Independent User. C1/C2: Proficient User

## References

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- Postdoc: **Dra. Elena Angulo**, Doñana Biological Station - CSIC, Seville (Spain)  
✉ angulo@ebd.csic.es
- PhD thesis: **Dra. Magdalena Witek**, Museum and Institute of Zoology, PAS, Warsaw (Poland)  
✉ mwitek@miiz.waw.pl; mawitus@yahoo.co.uk
- Master's thesis: **Dr. Xim Cerdá**, Doñana Biological Station - CSIC, Seville (Spain)  
✉ xim@ebd.csic.es
- Bachelor's thesis: **Prof. Dr. Ximo Baixeras**, University of Valencia, Valencia (Spain)  
✉ joaquin.baixeras@uv.es